Richco International Inc.

Forklifts (Power Industrial Trucks)

Purpose

To define the procedures and standards that apply to the care, control, maintenance, inspection, and operation of forklifts (powered industrial trucks).

Forklifts (powered industrial trucks) shall be operated, maintained, and controlled in a safe manner.

This policy covers minimum performance standards applicable to all Company Associates employees and locations. Local practices requiring more detailed or stringent rules, or local, state or other federal requirements regarding this subject can and should be added as an addendum to this procedure as applicable.

Scope

Company Associates work sites, i.e., company offices, client job sites, etc. requiring the use of forklifts (powered industrial trucks).

Definitions

Forklift means a mobile, power-propelled truck used to carry, push, pull, lift, stack, or tier materials. Powered industrial trucks (forklifts) are also commonly known as pallet trucks, rider trucks, fork trucks, or lift trucks.

Requirements

Training

Only trained and authorized persons are permitted to operate a forklift or other Power Industrial Truck. The Branch Safety Officer or designee will administer the forklift operator certification program and maintain training records.

Training shall occur prior to employee operation of any forklift, and at least every three years thereafter unless observed performance by the operator dictates the need for more frequent retraining. Classroom and Practical Training in addition to Operator Evaluation are required. Each trainee, who satisfactorily completes the qualifications as outlined above, shall be issued a written document as evidence of being a Qualified Forklift Operator.

Each manufacturer or un-similar model of Power Industrial Truck shall require individual Practical Training and Operator Evaluation prior to receiving authorization to operate.

Inspection and Maintenance

Prior to placing a forklift truck into service, the truck operator shall inspect their vehicle and document this inspection.

It is the responsibility of the department manager to submit the inspection checklists to the Safety Officer on a weekly basis. The Branch Safety Officer shall keep the last 30 days of inspection checklists for each forklift on file for review.

Any noted condition that affects the safe operation of the lift truck shall be reported to the operator's supervisor for corrective action and shall keep the lift truck from being operated until the unsafe condition is corrected.

Forklifts that are defective, in need of repair or are unsafe shall be tagged "Danger - Do Not Operate" and taken out of service until restored to safe operating condition.

A maintenance log shall be maintained for each forklift to determine when required maintenance is due. Only qualified personnel shall perform maintenance and repair. Maintenance records for each forklift shall be kept on file by the assigned department manager.

General Safe Operating Rules

The following safe operating rules apply to Associates employees who operate a forklift. Violations of safe operating rules can and will result in retraining and/or disciplinary action.

1) Only employees trained as per the requirements of this manual section and authorized by the department manager shall be allowed to operate forklifts

2) Forklifts shall not be loaned or rented to others for use.

3) Stunt driving and horseplay shall not be permitted.

4) Forklifts shall be equipped with seat belts and utilized by the operator when in use.

5) Personnel are not permitted to ride on forklifts except in designated seats that are part of the equipment design.

6) Forklifts shall be equipped with a portable fire extinguisher.

7) Under travel conditions, the forklift shall be operated at a speed that will permit it to be brought to a stop in a safe manner.

8) Traffic regulations shall be observed, including authorized work site speed limits. A safe distance shall be maintained approximately three forklift lengths from the forklift truck ahead.

9) The driver shall be required to slow down and sound the horn at cross aisles and other areas where vision is obstructed. If the load being carried obstructs forward view, the driver shall be required to travel with the load trailing.

10) The driver shall be required to look in the direction of and keep a clear view of the path of travel.

11) Forklifts shall have a functional horn and back-up alarm with a distinctive sound, loud enough to be heard clearly above background noises. There are other scenarios where a flashing yellow/amber light would be installed. An Addendum referencing any requirements of such lights shall be added to this manual section.

12) Copies of the manufacturer's operating instructions for each type of forklift shall be readily available for review by operators and supervisory personnel.

13) Lift trucks, stackers, etc., shall have the rated capacity clearly posted on the vehicle so as to be clearly visible to the operator. When the manufacturer provides auxiliary removable counterweights, corresponding alternate rated capacities also shall be clearly shown on the vehicle. These ratings shall not be exceeded.

14) No modifications or additions, which affect the capacity or safe operation of the equipment, shall be made without the manufacturer's written approval. If such modifications or changes are made, the capacity, operation, and maintenance instruction plates, tags, or decals shall be changed accordingly. In no case shall the original safety factor of the equipment be reduced.

15) Steering or spinner knobs shall not be attached to the steering wheel unless the steering mechanism is of a type that prevents road reactions from causing the steering hand wheel to spin. The steering knob shall be mounted within the periphery of the wheel.

16) Forklifts shall have the manufacturer's nameplate showing its weight with attachments, lifting capacity, lift height maximum and other pertinent data. Nameplates or markings shall be maintained in a legible condition and remain in place.

17) Railroad tracks shall be crossed diagonally wherever possible. Parking closer than 8 feet from the center of railroad tracks is prohibited.

18) Grades shall be ascended or descended slowly.

19) When ascending or descending grades in excess of 10 percent, loaded forklifts shall be driven with the load upgrade.

20) Unloaded forklifts should be operated on all grades with the load engaging means downgrade.

21) On grades, the load and load engaging means shall be tilted back if applicable and raised only as far as necessary tee clear the road surface.

22) No person shall be allowed to stand or pass under the elevated portion of any forklift, whether loaded or empty.

23) There shall be sufficient headroom under overhead installations, lights, pipes, sprinkler system, etc.

24) Arms or legs are prohibited from being placed between the uprights of the mast or outside the running lines of the forklift.

25) When a forklift is left unattended, load engaging means shall be fully lowered, controls shall be neutralized, power shall be shut off, and brakes set.

26) Wheels shall be blocked if parked on an incline.

27) A safe distance shall be maintained from the edge of ramps or platforms while on any elevated dock, or platform, or freight car. Forklifts shall not be used for opening or closing freight doors.

28) Brakes shall be set and wheel blocks shall be in place to prevent movement of trucks, trailers, or railroad cars while loading or unloading. Fixed jacks may be necessary to support a semi-trailer during loading or unloading when the trailer is not coupled to a tractor. Prior to forklift entry, the flooring and frames of trucks, trailers and railroad cars shall be checked for breaks and weakness before they are driven into and to determine if it will bare the intended weight of the forklift and intended load.

29) Dock board or bridge plates shall be properly secured before they are driven over. Dock board or bridge plates shall be driven over carefully and slowly, and their rated capacity never exceeded. Portable dock boards shall be secured in position, by being anchored or equipped with devices that will prevent their slipping.

30) An overhead guard shall be used as protection against falling objects. It should be noted that an overhead guard is intended to offer protection from the impact of small packages, boxes, bagged material. etc. representative of the job application, but not to withstand the impact of a falling capacity load.

Forklifts (Power Industrial Trucks)

31) Additional counter weighting of forklifts shall not be allowed unless approved by the manufacturer.

32) Employees shall not jump off a forklift.

33) Forklift operators shall yield to pedestrians.

34) Loads carried shall be secured on the forks to prevent upset / overturn.